



Scaling a Startup: Product, Marketing, and Operations for a Fitness App

¹Eloise Mendelson, ²Samuel Luff

¹The Peddie School, ²PaceLine



Introduction

Paceline was built to incentivize workouts through rewards and insurance benefits, attracting a user base of consistently active individuals. As Paceline acquires an insurance company and welcomes family-oriented policyholders who are less active, the current competitive leaderboard will lose effectiveness. To engage this new audience, the leaderboard must shift toward fostering organic growth through existing social groups and community-driven motivation.

Logistics and Implementation

- Insurance acquisition → new user onboarding(fig 1)
- Engineers seek to minimize additional workload within this large project
- Incoming users: diverse backgrounds, many without consistent exercise habits
- Existing users: fitness-oriented, competition-driven
- Gap: current users prefer competing with peers, not elite athletes or “bot-like” competitors

Roadmap

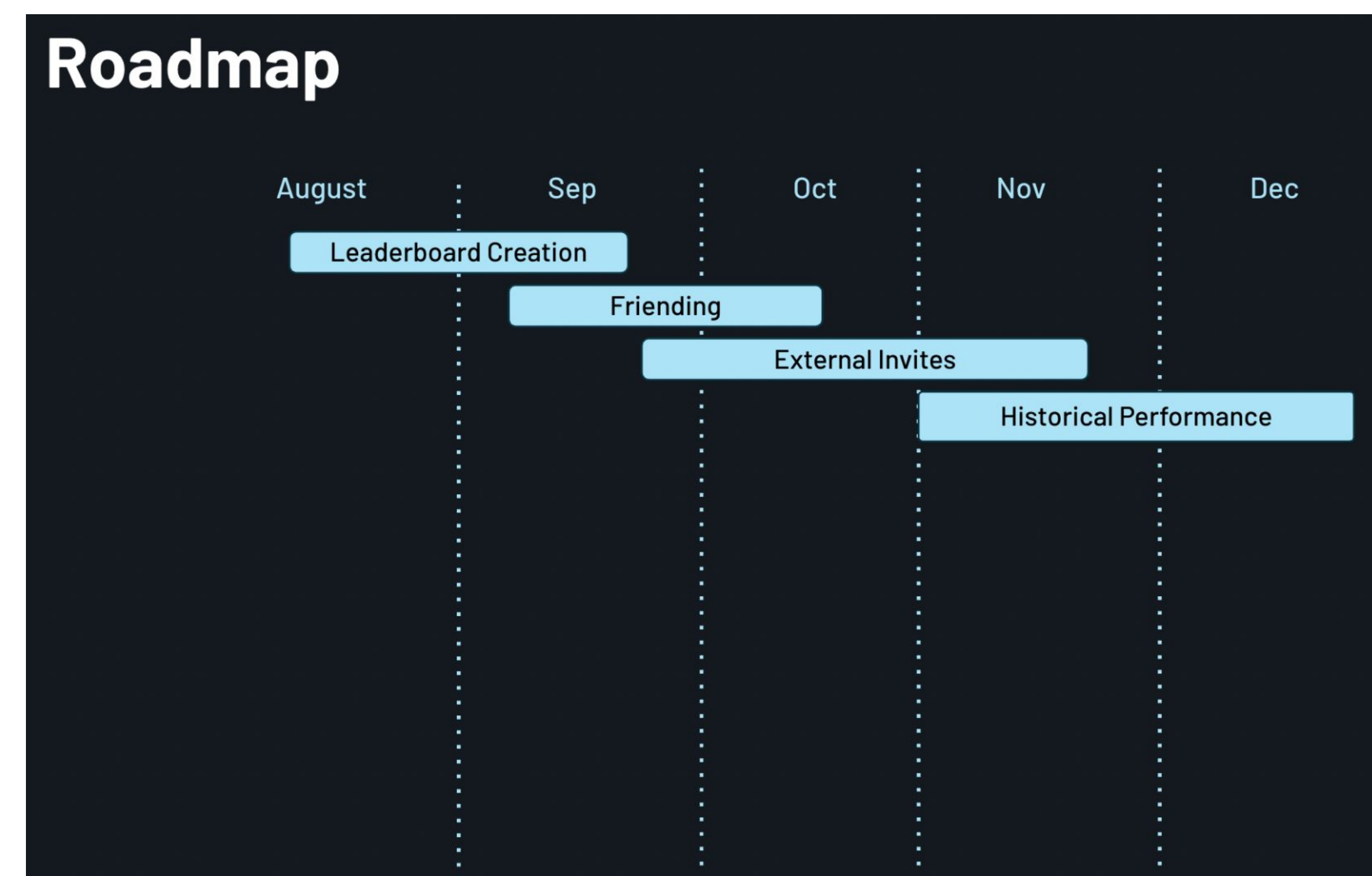


Fig 1: Product Roadmap and timeline for the implementation of the leader board

Social Media Marketing

The social media marketing efforts on Instagram, focused on the company’s insurance acquisition(fig 1,2,3). Demographics and interests of incoming users, were researched and analyzed, which helped tailor the content and engagement strategies to effectively onboard the expanded audience.

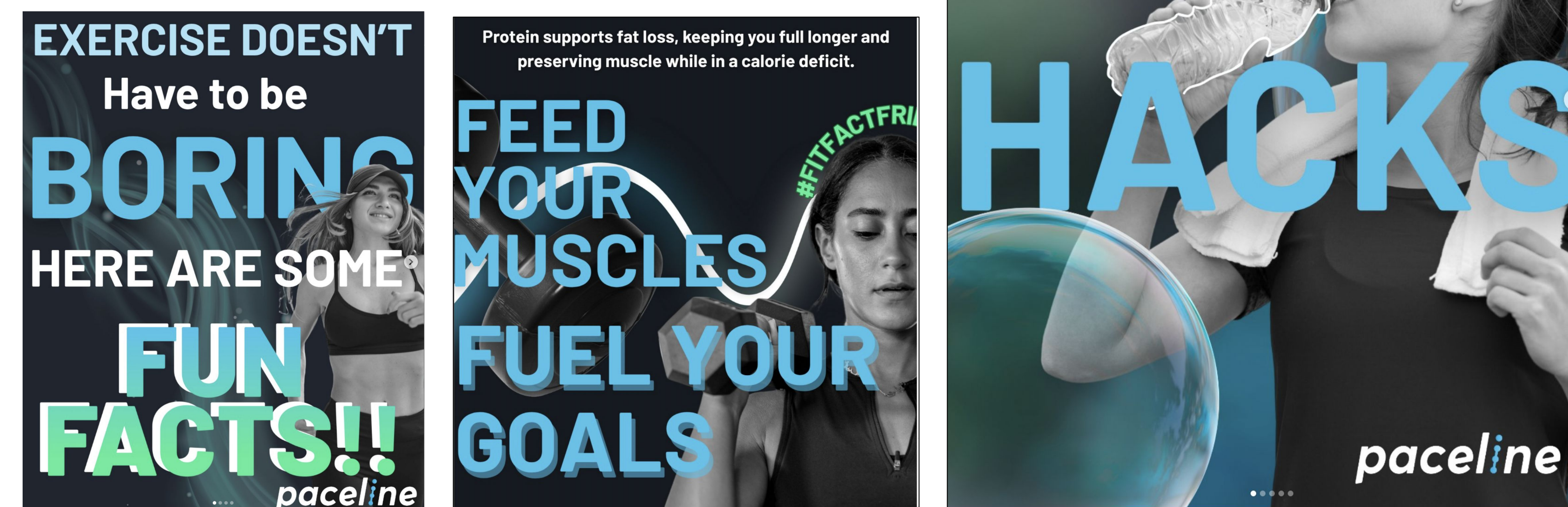


Fig 2,3,4: social media posts targeting new audience for summer

New Leaderboard

The new leaderboard fosters organic social interaction by letting users join multiple groups instead of being confined to one(fig 6,7). This creates meaningful competition with friends, co-workers, and communities, making the app more engaging and encouraging frequent check-ins—especially among the acquired insurance company’s user base(fig 5).

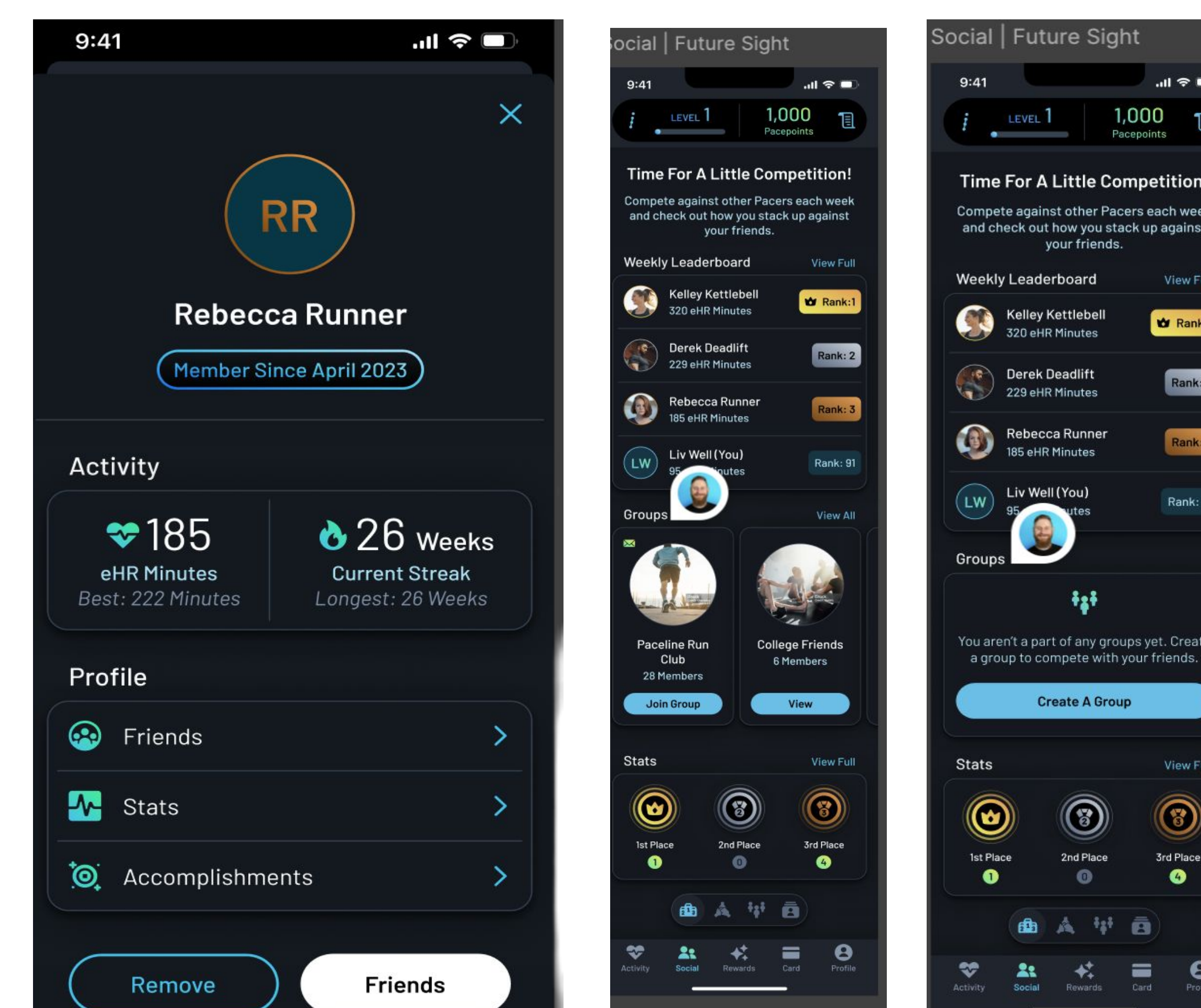


Fig 5: screen for accepting a friend, Fig 6, 7: leaderboard screen

My Experience

At Paceline, a fitness app startup undergoing an insurance acquisition, I gained cross-functional experience across product, marketing, and operations(fig 8). Highlights include leading a redesign of the leaderboard feature in collaboration with engineers, supporting social media marketing through research on incoming insurance users, streamlining internal organization with Notion and Jira, and conducting competitive market research to guide strategy, which provided first hand insight into the fast-paced, collaborative nature of startup environments.



Fig 8: venn diagram showing cross-functionality.



Fig 9 and 10: fun stuff I did in SF

Acknowledgements References

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